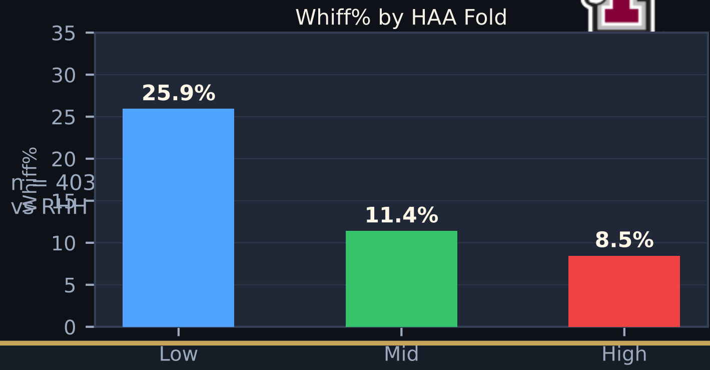
Beau Elson · LHP | Fastball HAA Analysis

Fordham Baseball A… 2026

14.2%	23.3%	57.1%
Whiff% (vs RHH)	CSW% (vs RHH)	Zone% (vs RHH)



KEY FINDING

Low HAA (≈1.08°) generates 25.9% Whiff% — 3× the rate of High HAA (8.5%).

When Beau's fastball exits the hand at a lower horizontal approach angle, it arrives from the 1B side and finishes outside to right-handed hitters. That deceptive approach angle makes it extremely difficult to square up, driving the dramatic difference in swing-and-miss rate across folds.

Low HAA (25.9% Whiff) Mid HAA (11.4% Whiff) High HAA (8.5% Whiff)

HAA and PlateLocSide share a 0.90 correlation — the approach angle dictates where the ball ends up, not the other way around.

TARGET RELEASE POINT

Overall mean RelSide: -2.35 ft

Low-HAA fold RelSide: -2.25 ft

Required shift: Δ = +0.10 ft (~1.2 in toward 1B/glove side)

For a LHP, moving the release point ~1.2 inches toward the 1B / glove side naturally lowers HAA. The ball arrives from the 1B side and stays outside to RHH — the most effective approach angle.

Fold	N	Avg HAA	Avg RelSide	Avg PlateLocSide	Swing%	Whiff%	CSW%	Zone%
Low	135	1.08°	-2.25 ft	-0.74 ft	40.0%	25.9%	28.1%	41.5%
Mid	134	2.12°	-2.35 ft	-0.05 ft	59.0%	11.4%	23.1%	73.9%
High	134	3.09°	-2.44 ft	+0.61 ft	53.0%	8.5%	18.7%	56.0%

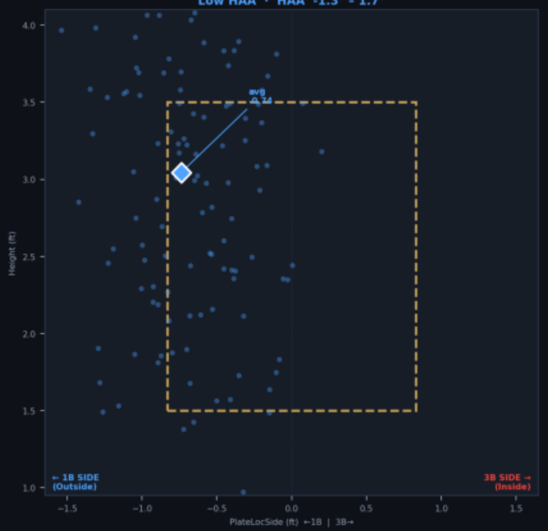
Pair with location discipline or pitch-to-contact mix.

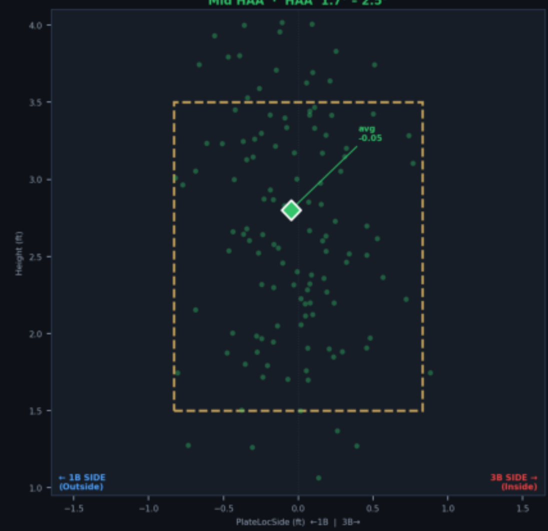
Beau Elson · HAA Fold Analysis

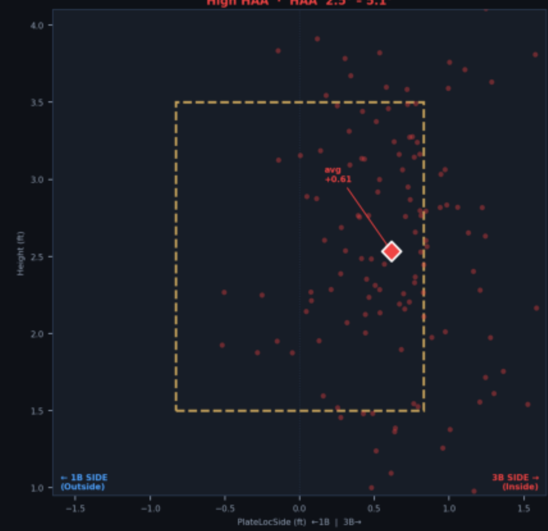
Fordham Baseball An 2026

Elson, Beau (LHP) — Fastball HAA Fold Analysis · vs RHH Only

Fastballs split into 3 equal HAA terciles · Positive HAA = ball arriving from 3B side (inside to RHH) · Negative/low HAA = ball arrives from 1B side (outside to RHH) · Low HAA most effective







Outside (1B side)	
N (vs RHH)	135
Avg HAA	1.08°
Avg Velo	89.3 mph
Avg Rel Side	-2.25 ft
Avg Location	-0.74 ft
Strike%	57.8%
Zone%	41.5%
CSW%	28.1%
Whiff%	25.9%

Ball stays 1B-side / away from RHH → Most whiffs, highest CSW

Middle	
N (vs RHH)	134
Avg HAA	2.12°
Avg Velo	89.2 mph
Avg Rel Side	-2.35 ft
Avg Location	-0.05 ft
Strike%	75.4%
Zone%	73.9%
CSW%	23.1%
Whiff%	11.7%

Ball works middle of plate → Moderate outcomes

Inside (3B side)	
N (vs RHH)	134
Avg HAA	3.09°
Avg Velo	88.9 mph
Avg Rel Side	-2.44 ft
Avg Location	+0.61 ft
Strike%	67.2%
Zone%	55.2%
CSW%	18.7%
Whiff%	8.5%

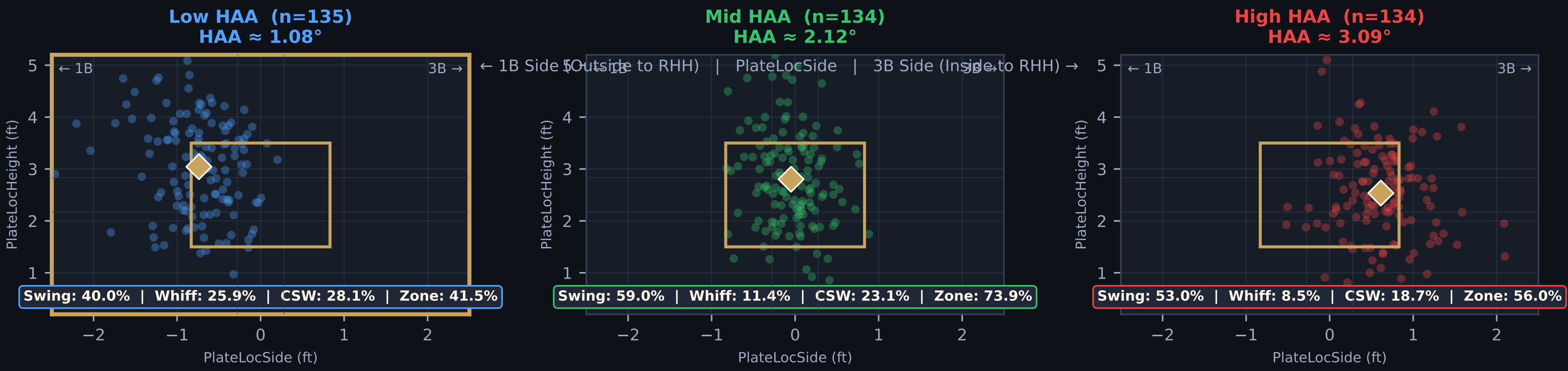
Ball runs inside (3B-side) to RHH → Harder to generate whiffs

Three HAA tercile folds (Low / Mid / High) vs RHH | Low fold: HAA ≈ 1.08° → 25.9% Whiff% · Mid fold: HAA ≈ 2.12° → 11.4% Whiff% · High fold: HAA ≈ 3.09° → 8.5% Whiff%

Generated from TrackMan data · Fordham Baseball Analytics · 2026

Beau Elson · Zone Location by HAA Fold (vs RHH)

Fordham Baseball Analytics · 2026



Fold Comparison Table (Fastball vs RHH)

Fold	N	Avg HAA	RelSide (ft)	PlateLocSide (ft)	Swing%	Whiff%	CSW%	Zone%	
Low	135	1.08°	-2.25	-0.74	40.0%	25.9%	28.1%	41.5%	← OPTIMAL
Mid	134	2.12°	-2.35	-0.05	59.0%	11.4%	23.1%	73.9%	
High	134	3.09°	-2.44	+0.61	53.0%	8.5%	18.7%	56.0%	

Generated from TrackMan data · Fordham Baseball Analytics · 2026

Beau Elson · Coaching Summary & Rubber Recommendation

Fordham Baseball An 2026

RUBBER / RELEASE RECOMMENDATION

Current mean RelSide:	**-2.35 ft**
Target RelSide (Low HAA fold):	**-2.25 ft**
Required shift:	**Δ = +0.10 ft ≈ 1.2 in toward 1B/glove side**
Expected outcome:	**Whiff% from ~14.2% (overall) into 25.9% range**

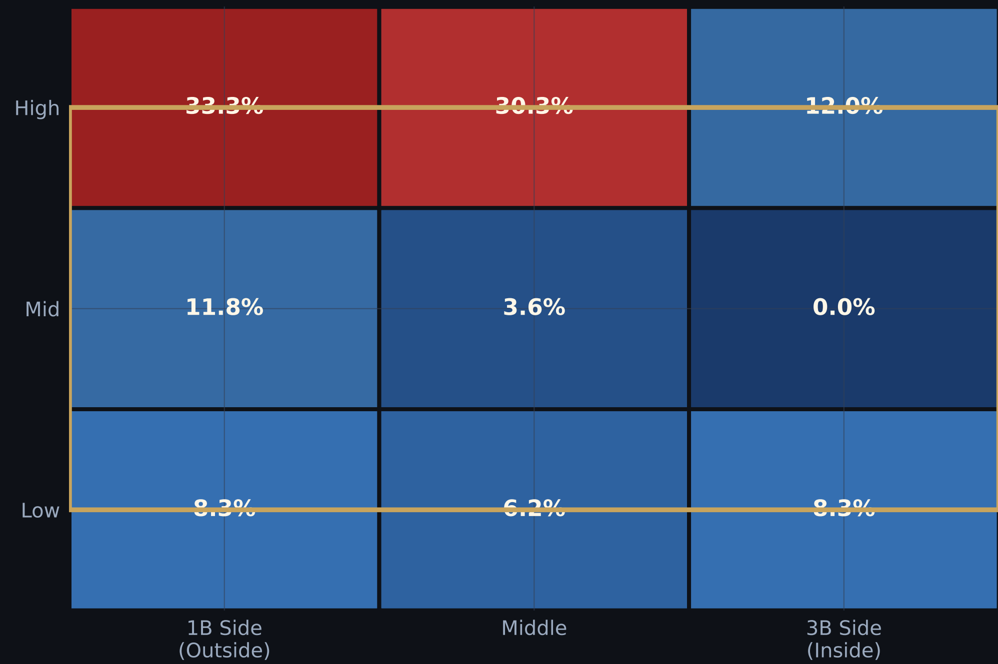
Mechanism:

For a LHP, moving release toward the 1B/glove side lowers HAA → ball arrives from 1B side → stays outside vs RHH → most effective approach angle.

Guardrail:

Zone% drops to 41.5% in Low-HAA fold (vs 73.9% Mid). Must pair with pitch-to-contact mix or sharp location discipline to maintain acceptable in-zone rates.

9-Zone Whiff% (All vs-RHH Fastballs)



STRATEGIC READ PER FOLD

LOW HAA (≈1.08°) — OPTIMAL

- Ball arrives from 1B side, finishing outside to RHH.
- 25.9% Whiff% — 3× the rate of High-HAA zone.
- Zone% is 41.5%; effective even when missing slightly off plate.
- Primary use case: put-away pitch / two-strike count; must spot carefully.

MID HAA (≈2.12°) — NEUTRAL

- Ball centers in the zone (PlateLocSide ≈ –0.05 ft). High Zone% (73.9%).
- Moderate swing-and-miss (11.4%). Good for early counts / strike-one sequencing.
- Effective when establishing zone presence before going to Low-HAA for whiff.

HIGH HAA (≈3.09°) — AVOID FOR WHIFFS

- Ball runs inside to RHH (PlateLocSide +0.61 ft). Harder to miss.
- Only 8.5% Whiff% — hitters can track and barrel the pitch.
- Zone% (56%) is moderate. Risk of hard contact on middle-in fastballs.
- Use sparingly; best only as a complementary location for pitch mix variety.